

# Ceili Mor Academy of Dance

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## PROPOSAL: Mylapore Metro Station Public Art Commission

|                |                                                             |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Submitted to   | Chennai Metro Rail Limited, Arts and Public Realm Committee |
| Submitted by   | Jean Mullen, Artistic Director, Ceili Mor Academy of Dance  |
| Commission ref | CMRL/PUBART/2025/14                                         |
| Date           | 22 January 2026                                             |
| Occasion       | Inauguration of Mylapore Metro Station, November 2026       |

### The work

I propose a site-specific dance installation and live performance titled *Threshold*, created for the concourse of the new Mylapore station. The piece reads the station as a place of crossing, between neighbourhoods, between the old Mylapore of temple and church and the new city the line connects. It blends the grounded footwork of the Irish tradition I carry with the gestural vocabulary of Chennai's own dance languages, set against a digital projection that moves with the dancers across the concourse wall.

### Two components

1. A live inauguration-day performance by eight dancers of the academy's advanced troupe, with live bodhran and fiddle, lasting twenty minutes, repeated twice across the opening event.
2. A standing projection installation, a looping six-minute movement film mapped to the concourse wall, designed to run during station hours for the first month, so commuters meet the work daily, not only on the opening.

### Why this team

The academy has built contemporary Irish dance in Chennai for fourteen years and knows how to make tradition speak to a contemporary public. The projection language developed here will share its visual grammar with *Five Elements*, my festival premiere this December, so the city sees one artistic voice across two civic moments. I work with a trusted projection designer and the same musicians who have played with me for over a decade.

### Budget and timeline

| Item                                             | Amount (Rs)     |
|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Choreography and creative direction              | 1,50,000        |
| Dancers and musicians, rehearsal and performance | 2,20,000        |
| Projection design, filming, and mapping          | 2,80,000        |
| Equipment hire and installation                  | 1,40,000        |
| Documentation and contingency                    | 60,000          |
| <b>Total commission cost</b>                     | <b>8,50,000</b> |

Rehearsals October to November 2026. Installation built and tested ahead of the November inauguration. I would be glad to present this in person to the committee.